CHAOS ENGINEERING / FEATURE FLAGS

TEST IN PRODUCTION (SAFELY)

Resilience cannot be proven in staging — it must be demonstrated under real production conditions. Chaos engineering deliberately introduces controlled failures to verify that resilience mechanisms actually work. Feature flags limit blast radius on every release.

KEY BENEFITS

- ✓ Validates that failover, circuit breakers, and fallbacks actually work under load
- ✓ Builds team confidence and on-call muscle memory before a real emergency
- ✓ Uncovers hidden dependencies and single points of failure proactively
- ✓ Feature flags reduce deployment risk — any release can be instantly toggled off

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Netflix's Chaos Monkey — which randomly terminates production instances — has been running since 2011. Teams running chaos experiments have dramatically lower MTTR when real failures occur.

PRACTICAL EXAMPLE

Every Tuesday the team kills one random microservice during business hours. This week they discover their circuit breaker timeout was misconfigured. Fixed in 20 minutes — before a real failure exposes it at the worst possible time.

REFLECTION QUESTION

Have you ever deliberately killed a production service to verify your failover works? Would you be confident to?